iBITS

Institute of Brilliant Information Technology Students

Constitution and By-Laws

2025 Revision

Preamble

We, the Institute of Brilliant Information Technology Students (iBITS) of the Polytechnic University of the Philippines Lopez Quezon (Lopez Campus) united by our common passion for information technology and committed to academic excellence, professional development, and ethical conduct, hereby establish this organization. Recognizing the rapidly evolving landscape of technology, we aim to foster an environment that encourages innovation, collaboration, and lifelong learning. Through this organization, we pledge to support our members in their academic and professional endeavors, promote community engagement, and contribute to the advancement of the field of information technology. Guided by the principles of integrity, inclusiveness, and service, we dedicate ourselves to the pursuit of knowledge, the sharing of skills, and the development of a supportive network that empowers every member to achieve their full potential.

Mission

The mission of the iBITS organization is to promote and support the university's agenda in ensuring the effective use of information technology. Through our initiatives and activities, we strive to empower students to harness technology for academic and professional excellence, contributing to the overall advancement of the university community.

Vision

The vision of the iBITS organization is to educate and build a comprehensive quality education for all its members. We aim to develop well-rounded IT professionals equipped with the knowledge, skills, and ethical values necessary to excel in the dynamic field of information technology, thereby fostering a culture of continuous learning and innovation.

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Article I
Name and Domicile

Section 1. Name of the Organization

The official academic organization of the Bachelor of Science in Information Technology (BSIT**)** and Diploma in Information Technology (DIT) shall be known as "Institute of Brilliant Information Technology Students".

1.1 No members or officers of the Organization have the authority to change the name of the Organization. Any change to the name must be decided by the Organization's Advisers and its members.
1.2 The proper abbreviation of the Organization, "iBITS," must be used correctly in any context or format, including letters, projects, and social media posts.
1.3 The name of the Organization may be used in the following:
1.3.1 Letters
1.3.2 Meetings
1.3.3 Activities
1.4 Any illegal use of the Organization's name shall be subject to investigation. Requests must be submitted to ensure the rightful use of the Organization's name.

Section 2. Domicile of the Organization

The official domicile of the organization shall be at the Polytechnic University of the Philippines, Lopez, Quezon Campus, where its activities, programs, and communications shall primarily be conducted.

2.1 In the absence of a designated office space, the organization shall utilize available university facilities, online platforms, and other designated venues as approved by the officials for meetings, activities, and operations.
2.2 The custody and maintenance of organizational resources and records shall be the responsibility of the officers, with the cooperation of members, regardless of the location where organizational functions are carried out.

Article II

Organizational Logo and Colors

Section 1. Usage of the Organizational Logo

1.1 The official logo of the organization may only be used with the explicit approval of the organization's officers and advisers.

1.2 Unauthorized use of the organizational logo for any fraudulent activities or solicitations, without proper consent and advisement from the officers, will result in disciplinary action.

Section 2. Approved Applications for the Logo

2,1 The organizational logo may be used in various official capacities, including but not limited to:

2.1.1 Application Forms
2.1.2 Official Letters
2.1.3 Financial Reports
2.1.4 Organization Reports
2.1.5 Social Media Post
2.1.6 Organizational apparel (e.g., shirts, polos)

2.2 The use of the logo in these and other contexts must be approved by the appropriate authorities within the organization.

Section 3. Organizational Colors

3.1 The official colors of the organization shall be Golden Yellow and Black.

3.2 The logo features a black-labeled circle, with an iBITS design in a chip style at the center, symbolizing the aspirations and dreams of IT students.

Section 4. Slogan and Symbolism

The official slogan of iBITS shall be "We code as one," symbolizing unity and collaboration among members. The handsign of the number 1 will be the official gesture to represent this unity and the collective strength of the organization.

Article III

Declaration of the Principles and Objectives

Section 1. Objectives and Purposes

The objectives and purposes of the Institute of Brilliant Information Technology Students (iBITS) are as follows:

1.1 To support IT students in their growth and professional development by providing opportunities in a dynamic environment.
1.2 To foster a positive learning environment for applying IT applications.
1.3 To enhance physical facilities to support the organization's programs effectively.
1.4 To improve and expand educational and community programs.
1.5 To develop fellowship opportunities within the organization and the extended community.
1.6 To improve the maintainability of new systems.
1.7 To develop applications for efficient information distribution and increase member awareness of technology trends.
1.8 To maintain high-quality technical education related to Information Technology.
1.9 To encourage active participation of members in university activities.
1.10 To adopt measures for educational advancement in Technology.
1.11 To promote IT literacy in communities through research and extension.
1.12 To advocate academic excellence through knowledge and skills sharing among IT students.
1.13 To inspire members to be solution-oriented and goal-driven.
1.14 To establish linkages with external IT organizations.
1.15 To promote fellowship and camaraderie among IT students within and outside the campus.

Article IV
Membership

Section 1. Membership Eligibility

Membership is exclusive to students enrolled in the Bachelor of Science in Information Technology (BSIT) and Diploma in Information Technology programs at the Polytechnic University of the Philippines, Lopez Quezon Campus. Members must pledge to undertake the responsibilities of the organization and agree to its terms and conditions.

Section 2. Application and Fees

2.1 Membership applications must be submitted in online using the AMF 2024 (Application Membership Form). The application must be accompanied by a membership fee. Application forms are provided by the Executive Secretary.
2.2 The membership fee is three hundred pesos (P300.00) per semester. Additional funds may be generated for miscellaneous purposes as necessary or through fundraising activities.

Section 3. Purpose of Membership Fee

The membership fee of three hundred pesos (₱300.00) per semester is allocated to support the following:

3.1 Funding for various organizational activities, including trainings, seminars, and workshops.
3.2 Ensuring the overall smooth operation of the organization's functions.
3.3 Supporting flagship projects and programs of the organization, implemented each academic year in line with its mission and vision.

Section 4. Membership Benefits

Active members, defined as those who have paid their membership fees, are entitled to the following benefits:

4.1 Free access to trainings, seminars, tutorials, workshops, and similar activities.
4.2 Opportunities to be sponsored as official delegates or representatives to various national or international conferences, competitions, and other beneficial activities.
4.3 The right to vote and be elected by the general membership.
4.4 Recommendations by the organization for various student exchange programs and similar opportunities.
4.5 The ability to borrow equipment from the organization, subject to the completion of an equipment request form and approval by the officers.

Section 5. Termination of Membership

Membership may be terminated if a member shifts or transfers to another program or school. Termination must be conducted through counseling with the organization advisers with proper turnover of credentials to ensure security and credibility.

Section 6. Organization Polo and Shirt

6.1 All new members are required to purchase the official organization polo, which will have a unique design for each academic year to distinguish different batches.

6.2 Returning members may instead purchase the organization T-shirt, which will follow the same design theme as the polo.

6.3 The official organization polo or T-shirt must be worn on designated "Org Shirt/Polo Day" and during official activities as required.

Article V

Responsibility of Members

Section 1: Attendance at Events/Programs

1.1 Attending events or programs organized by iBITS is a fundamental responsibility of all members. These events are designed to foster community, enhance learning, and promote the overall mission of the organization.

1.2 Participation in these events not only benefits individual members but also contributes to the collective success and vibrancy of the organization. Active involvement is essential in building a strong sense of unity and belonging within the iBITS community.

1.3 Members who are absent from an organization event or program shall incur fines as follows:

1.3.1 Members: One Hundred Pesos (₱100.00)
1.3.2 Class Officers: One Hundred Fifty Pesos (₱150.00)
1.3.3 Organization Officers: Three Hundred Pesos (₱300.00)

Section 2. Additional Fines for Non-iBITS Activities/Events

If the President requires attendance at a non-iBITS activity or non-iBITS event, the fines for non-attendance are as follows:

2.1 Non-iBITS Events and Activities: Lower fines compared to organization events.

2.1.1 Members: Fifty Pesos (₱50.00)
2.1.2 Class Officers: One Hundred Pesos (₱100.00)
2.1.3 Organization Officers: One Hundred Fifty Pesos (₱150.00)

Article VI
Board of Officers

Section 1. The Board

The general administration affairs of the organization shall be in the hands of a board of officers consisting of the following positions:

- President
- Vice President
- General Secretary
  - Assistant Secretary
- Treasurer
  - Assistant Treasurer
- Auditor
  - Assistant Auditor
- COMELEC Officer

Section 2. President

2.1 The President shall be the chief executive of the organization.
2.2 The President shall exercise general supervision and control over the organization's affairs and ensure the faithful implementation of policies, programs, and resolutions approved by the Board.
2.3 The President shall preside at all general and Board meetings and represent the organization in official functions.
2.4 The President shall, when authorized by the Board, sign contracts or agreements on behalf of the organization and ensure orderly turnover at the end of the term.

Section 3. Vice President

3.1 The Vice President shall assist the President in the performance of their duties and in the coordination of Board activities.
3.2 The Vice President shall oversee and coordinate committees or special projects as assigned by the Board.
3.3 The Vice President shall assume and perform the duties of the President in the latter's absence, incapacity, or temporary inability to serve.

Section 4. General Secretary

4.1 The General Secretary shall keep the minutes of all meetings of the Board and the general membership.
4.2 The General Secretary shall maintain custody of official records, correspondence, and documents of the organization.
4.3 The General Secretary shall prepare and distribute notices, agendas, and other official communications and ensure proper turnover of records at term end.

Section 5. Assistant Secretary

5.1 The Assistant Secretary shall assist the General Secretary in all duties and maintain attendance and membership records.

5.2 The Assistant Secretary shall assume the duties of the General Secretary in their absence.

5.3 The Assistant Secretary shall support documentation and archival tasks as directed by the Board.

Section 6. Treasurer

6.1 The Treasurer shall keep and maintain accurate books of accounts and financial records of the organization.

6.2 The Treasurer shall collect and receive membership fees, donations, and other funds in the name of the organization and issue official receipts.

6.3 The Treasurer shall prepare periodic financial statements and assist in the preparation of the annual/term financial report.

Section 7. Assistant Treasurer

7.1 The Assistant Treasurer shall assist the Treasurer in all financial duties and recordkeeping.

7.2 The Assistant Treasurer shall assume the duties of the Treasurer in their absence.

7.3 The Assistant Treasurer shall help ensure proper safekeeping of funds and compliance with Board disbursement policies.

Section 8. Auditor

8.1 The Auditor shall conduct periodic and special audits of the organization's financial records and transactions.

8.2 The Auditor shall ensure transparency and accountability in all financial matters and report any irregularities to the Board.

8.3 The Auditor shall present audit findings and recommend corrective measures as necessary.

Section 9. Assistant Auditor

9.1 The Assistant Auditor shall assist the Auditor in audit preparations and financial reviews.

9.2 The Assistant Auditor shall assume the duties of the Auditor in their absence.

9.3 The Assistant Auditor shall aid in documenting audit results and follow-up actions.

Section 10. COMELEC Officer

10.1 The COMELEC Officer shall oversee the conduct of elections and other electoral processes in accordance with the constitution and by-laws.

10.2 The COMELEC Officer shall prepare and publish election guidelines, schedules, and official results.

10.3 The COMELEC Officer shall receive and adjudicate election-related complaints and ensure fair and transparent elections.

Section 10. Committees

The Board shall establish standing committees to assist in carrying out organizational functions. The standing committees are: Academic Committee; Sports Committee; Cultural Committee; Institutional Committee; Publicity and Creative Media Committee; Networking Committee; and STRAW (Students' Rights and Welfare) Committee.

a.) Each committee shall have a Chairperson and a Vice-Chairperson appointed or endorsed by the Board. Committees shall prepare a program of activities, coordinate budgetary requests with the Board, implement approved programs, and submit post-activity reports and documentation to the Board within two (2) weeks after each event.

b.) Committees shall follow the general duties below; specific tasks may be assigned by the Board or described in the Board's operating procedures.

10.1 Academic Committee

The Academic Committee is responsible for supporting the academic growth of members by organizing tutorials, seminars, workshops, and academic competitions, as well as coordinating mentoring or speaker engagements to strengthen academic performance and professional development.

10.2 Sports Committee

The Sports Committee is tasked with planning and managing sports activities, including intramurals and training sessions, arranging venues and equipment, and promoting physical fitness, fair play, and sportsmanship within the organization.

10.3 Cultural Committee

The Cultural Committee oversees the planning and execution of cultural events such as pageants, showcases, and performances, ensuring that artistic and cultural expression is promoted while coordinating rehearsals, production, and participation.

10.4 Institutional Committee

The Institutional Committee handles organizational coordination with university offices, including the processing of permits, reservations, and official clearances, while ensuring that all activities comply with institutional rules and campus policies.

10.5 Publicity and Creative Media Committee

The Publicity and Creative Media Committee manages all documentation, creative outputs, and publicity efforts of the organization, including graphic design, photography, videography, and official social media accounts, to ensure effective promotion of programs and activities.

10.6 Networking Committee

The Networking Committee is in charge of building and maintaining partnerships with other organizations, alumni, and external stakeholders by seeking collaboration opportunities, sponsorships, and linkages that benefit the organization's objectives.

10.7 STRAW (Students' Rights and Welfare) Committee

The STRAW (Students' Rights and Welfare) Committee is dedicated to protecting and promoting student rights and welfare, addressing concerns of the student body, and organizing advocacy initiatives and welfare programs in coordination with the Board.

Article VII
Election Process

Section 1. Filing of Candidacy

1.1 Any member of the organization who is willing to serve as an officer must submit the following as part of their application:
  1.1.1 Certificate of Candidacy (COC)

Section 2. Election of Officers

2.1 The election of officers shall be held at least two weeks before the end of the second semester. The time and venue will be determined by the organization's presiding officers.
2.2 The senior outgoing officers and adviser will establish and oversee the rules and regulations for the election process.
2.3 Re-election to the same position is limited to two (2) consecutive terms.
2.4 Any vacancy, except for the presidency, shall be filled by an appointee selected by a majority vote of the incumbent officers, who will serve the remainder of the term.
2.5 Succession applies only to the vice president in the event of a vacancy in the presidency.
2.6 The top candidates who receive the highest votes will be proclaimed as elected officers.
2.7 In the event of a tie, a contingent election will be held among the tied candidates to fill the vacant positions.
2.8 The election process, including candidate filing, must be completed at least one month before the election proper. The election proper must be held no later than two weeks before the end of the academic year, with any contingent elections held within one week after the initial election.
2.9 The elected officials shall hold their respective functions and duties for one (1) school year and until their successors shall have been duly elected and inducted.
2.10 Any elected officer of the organization cannot hold any position in their respective classrooms.

Section 3. General Election Rules

1.1 The election of officers will be supervised by the Commission on Election (COMELEC).
1.2 Elections must be conducted using a computerized system provided by the commission. The current and interim officers hold the authority to accept or decline positions.
1.3 The president may be appointed or elected to any lower position.
1.4 The qualifications and other requirements for candidacy will be set by the COMELEC.

Article VIII
Accountability/Impeachment

Section 1. Accountability of Officers

All officers of the organization are accountable to the organization and are expected to serve with the utmost honesty, loyalty, and commitment.

Section 2. Grounds for Removal/Impeachment

An officer may be removed or impeached based on the following grounds:

2.1 Malversation of funds
- 2.1.1 Any officer found guilty of misusing or embezzling the organization's funds.

2.2 Gross negligence and misconduct

Any officer whose gross negligence results in:
- 2.2.1 Physical injuries to any member or officer.
- 2.2.2 Property loss or damage.
- 2.2.3 Damage to the reputation of the organization.

2.3 Culpable violation of the constitution
- 2.3.1 Any officer who violates the constitution or any provisions that are deemed prejudicial to the best interest of the organization by the council.

2.4 Habitual Absenteeism

An officer may be removed due to habitual absenteeism from the following activities and events:
- 2.4.1 Meetings or Team Building/Strategy Planning Activities: Attending less than 50% of the total number of meetings (both Regular and Special).
- 2.4.2 Events: Attending less than 40% of the total duration (in minutes) of internal or external events.

2.5 Acts Unbecoming of a Leader

Any officer displaying the following unacceptable behavior:
- 2.5.1 Oral defamation.
- 2.5.2 Public/scandalous behavior.
- 2.5.3 Theft.
- 2.5.4 Any violation in line with Section 14 Tenure, Leave of Absence, and Honorable Dismissal of the University Student Handbook.

2.6 Non-performance of Duties and Responsibilities

Any officer whose negligible performance results in delays or poor performance of the organization, as evidenced by consistent failing performance evaluations administered every quarter of an Academic Year (A.Y.).

Section 3. Absence-Based Removal

Any officer who incurs five inexcusable absences during the organization's meetings may be removed from office.

Section 4. Impeachment Process

4.1 Any officer may be impeached upon a written petition of the majority of the organization's members, submitted to the office of the accrediting body.
4.2 The impeachment court shall comprise one adviser and at least two iBITS officers.
4.3 At least 50% of the total population of members is required to file for an impeachment.
4.4 The case shall be substantiated based on the stated grounds for impeachment, ensuring objectivity and preventing cases motivated by ulterior motives.
4.5 The investigation and judgment of impeachment shall be conducted by the appropriate authorities.

Article IX
Meetings

Section 1. Meetings

1.1 Meetings of the organization shall be held at a time and place designated by the body.

1.2 Special meetings may be called from time to time by the President or a majority of the members of the organization.

Section 2. Absences and Fines

Officers or members who are absent from a meeting called by the President without justifiable reasons and a request letter from the Executive Secretary shall incur a fine of one hundred pesos (P100.00).

Section 3. Meetings and Assemblies

3.1 General Assembly:

3.1.1 May be called for on matters deemed critical by the officers.

3.1.2 Notice for the exact date, time, and place shall be disseminated at least two (2) weeks in advance.

3.2 Special Assembly:

3.2.1 May be called by most of the officers, with notice disseminated at least two (2) weeks in advance.

3.3 Regular Meetings:

3.3.1 Organization officers shall hold weekly meetings throughout the academic year at a date, time, and place fixed by the President or the presiding officer.

3.4 Special Meetings:

3.4.1 May be called by the President or presiding officer (adviser), with notice disseminated at least one (1) day in advance.

3.5 Notice of Meeting:

3.5.1 Must contain an agenda relevant to the meeting's purpose.

3.6 Quorum:

3.6.1 A quorum (50% of the total number of expected participants plus one) is required for all meetings and assemblies to validate transactions and agreements.

Section 4. Confidentiality

4.1 Discussions, decisions, and information shared during meetings or organizational activities must remain confidential and not be disclosed outside the office without explicit permission from the President.

4.2 Any member or officer found guilty of disclosing confidential information without permission shall incur a fine of Five Hundred Pesos (P500.00).

Article X
Excuse Letter

Section 1: Submission Requirements

1.1 Excuse letters should be addressed to the Executive Secretary and must include the date of submission.
1.2 The letter must clearly state the reason for the absence, the date of the missed event or activity, and any supporting documentation (e.g., medical certificate, proof of academic commitment).
1.3 The letter must be signed by the concerned member or officer.
1.3.1 If the reason for the absence is health-related, the letter should also include the signature of a medical professional.
1.3.2 For academic-related excuses, the letter must include the class adviser's signature as proof of concurrent academic commitments.

Section 2. Acceptable Reasons for Excuse Letters

2.1 Medical emergencies or serious health conditions, verified by a medical certificate.
2.2 Important family emergencies, such as the hospitalization or funeral of an immediate family member.
2.3 Concurrent academic commitments, such as final exams or mandatory class presentations, supported by valid proof from the class adviser.

Section 3: Submission Deadline

Excuse letters must be submitted no later than one week after the event or activity for them to be considered valid.

Section 4: Review and Approval

4.1 The Executive Secretary will review the excuse letters and verify the provided documentation.
4.2 Decisions regarding the validity of the excuse and any related penalties or exemptions will be communicated to the concerned member or officer.

Article XI

Sources of Fund and Fund Management

Section 1. Sources of Fund

1.1 The organization shall have a general fund, derived from membership fees and contributions, as well as from funds raised through the organization's fundraising projects.

1.2 General funds are intended to finance the overall operations of the organization, enabling it to effectively carry out its programs and projects.

1.3 Special funds are allocated for specific purposes and are intended to finance special projects as determined by the officers, unless realigned in cases of emergency.

1.4 Any remaining amount at the end of the school year shall be transferred to the general fund of the organization.

Section 2. Fundraising Projects

The organization shall undertake fundraising projects to generate additional funds, which will be added to the general fund.

Section 3. Membership Contributions

Membership fees shall be collected from students every semester, excluding the summer term.

Section 4. Fund Disbursement and Management

4.1 Disbursements shall be carried out by the Treasurer to authorized recipients, in accordance with an approved budget by the majority of officers.

4.2 The disbursement of funds shall adhere to a system determined by the majority of officers.

4.2 Reimbursement shall be limited to the actual amount incurred for financing approved programs or projects. In emergency situations, reimbursement shall cover actual needs as certified by the Auditor.

Section 5. Auditing

5.1 The organization shall conduct a monthly audit to review all expenses incurred to ensure transparency and accountability.

5.2 Each class under iBITS is required to undergo an audit of their expenses at the end of every semester.

Section 6. Liquidation

Liquidation of cash advances and project expenses shall be completed within 7 days of the regular disbursement.

Section 7. Reimbursement

7.1 Reimbursement shall be limited to the actual amount incurred for financing the implementation or conduct of approved programs or projects.

7.2 In emergency situations, reimbursement shall cover the actual needs of the situation, as certified by either the Auditor.

Article XII

Amendments and Effectivity

Section 1. Amendments

1.1 Amendments or revisions may be proposed by the Board of Officers with a plurality vote among its members.

1.2 Any objections from the general membership will be considered, and revisions to the by-laws may be initiated. The President shall appoint a capable individual to oversee the revision process.

1.3 Amendments to the iBITS Constitution and By-Laws shall take effect upon ratification by the majority of the general assembly, to occur within a few weeks, but not longer than one month after approval.

1.4 All proposed amendments must receive approval from the iBITS advisers before being presented to the general assembly for ratification.

Section 2. Effectivity

2.1 This Constitution shall take effect immediately upon its ratification by the majority of the members and shall supersede any previous constitutions and amendments.

2.2 The first election under this Constitution should be held not less than one month before the end of the academic year.

2.3 In witness thereof, this Constitution and By-Laws were signed on the ____ day of _____, _____, at the Polytechnic University of the Philippines, Lopez Campus, Lopez, Quezon.